

Utah.gov

WCAG 2.1 Accessibility Audit & EDS Migration Plan

CONFIDENTIAL REPORT

11 Pages Audited

Target: <https://www.utah.gov> (11 pages)

Audit Date: March 12, 2026

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA

Tool: axe-core 4.7.2 + Manual Testing

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Pages Audited
3. Site-Wide Accessibility Issues
4. Per-Page Audit Results
5. Page Structure Analysis for EDS Migration
6. EDS Migration Plan with Accessibility Remediation
7. Appendix: Detailed Data Tables

1. Executive Summary

Overall Assessment

Across **11 pages** of utah.gov, the site demonstrates a **consistent accessibility baseline** with 24–28 WCAG rules passing per page. However, **systemic issues** repeat across every page, indicating problems rooted in the shared UTDS framework rather than individual content. The most pervasive issues are: the **inaccessible logo link** (all 11 pages), **color contrast concerns** (all 11 pages), and **images without proper alt text** (all 11 pages, totaling 139 problematic images).

Migrating to Adobe Edge Delivery Services (EDS) provides a **structural opportunity** to fix all systemic issues at the framework level, ensuring every page benefits from proper semantic HTML, heading hierarchy, and accessible components.

11

PAGES SCANNED

15

TOTAL VIOLATIONS

139

IMAGE ALT ISSUES

349

SMALL TOUCH
TARGETS

2. Pages Audited

#	Page Title	URL	Violations	Passes	Needs Review
1	Home	utah.gov/index.html	2	27	2
2	Online Services	utah.gov/services/	1	27	2
3	Government	utah.gov/government/	2	26	2
4	Business	utah.gov/business/	1	26	2
5	Employment	utah.gov/employment/	1	26	2
6	Education	utah.gov/education/	1	26	2
7	Visit Utah	utah.gov/visit/	2	24	2
8	Residents	utah.gov/local/	1	28	2

#	Page Title	URL	Violations	Passes	Needs Review
9	About	utah.gov/about/	1	26	2
10	Disclaimer	utah.gov/support/disclaimer.html	1	24	2
11	Accessibility	utah.gov/support/accessibility.html	2	28	2

3. Site-Wide Accessibility Issues

These issues were found **across multiple or all pages**, indicating systemic problems in the shared framework/template.

3.1 Critical & Serious (Systemic)

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Pages	Details
1	Logo link without accessible name	2.4.4 / 4.1.2 (A)	Serious	11/11	The <code>.utds-title-wrapper</code> logo link has no <code>aria-label</code> , no visible text, and the image is <code>role="presentation"</code> . Present on every single page.
2	Color contrast failures	1.4.3 (AA)	Serious	11/11	Every page has elements flagged for potential or confirmed contrast failures. Ranges from 5 to 28 elements per page. The Government and Accessibility pages have confirmed violations; others need manual review.
3	Images without proper alt text	1.1.1 (A)	Serious	11/11	139 total images across all pages have empty <code>alt=""</code> without <code>role="presentation"</code> . The Residents page alone has 29 problematic images. Service icons, social media icons, and decorative images are all affected.

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Pages	Details
4	Invalid ARIA attribute value	4.1.2 (A)	Critical	11/11	Every page has 1 element with a potentially invalid ARIA attribute value (flagged as "incomplete" by axe). Appears to be in the shared header component. Needs manual verification.
5	Undersized touch targets	2.5.5 / 2.5.8	Moderate	11/11	349 total interactive elements below 44×44px across all pages. Ranges from 21 (Employment) to 53 (Residents). The shared header elements (banner button, sign-in, hamburger) are consistently undersized.

3.2 Page-Specific Issues

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Pages	Details
6	Missing H1 heading	1.3.1 (A)	Serious	1/11	Homepage only — no H1 element. All other pages properly have H1.
7	Heading level skips	1.3.1 (A)	Moderate	3/11	Residents, About, and Government pages skip from H2 to H5 for "Map Legend" heading. About page also skips H1→H3.
8	iframe without title	4.1.2 (A)	Serious	1/11	Visit page has a YouTube iframe without a title attribute.

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Pages	Details
9	Empty link (no text)	2.4.4 / 4.1.2 (A)	Serious	1/11	Government page has an empty link to auditor.utah.gov with no text content.
10	Contrast failure on Submit button	1.4.3 (AA)	Serious	1/11	Accessibility page's own "Submit" button (<code>.button.color--green</code>) fails contrast. Irony given the page's purpose.
11	Confirmed contrast violations (14 elements)	1.4.3 (AA)	Serious	1/11	Government page has 14 confirmed contrast failures across navigation links and breadcrumbs.
12	Homepage auto-rotating hero	2.2.2 (A)	Moderate	1/11	Auto-cycling background images with no pause control.
13	Duplicate ID	4.1.1 (A)	Minor	1/11	Homepage has duplicate <code>id="home-localResources"</code> .

3.3 Things Done Well (All Pages)

- **PASS** Skip-to-main-content link present on all 11 pages
- **PASS** `lang="en"` set on HTML element on all pages
- **PASS** Proper landmark regions on all pages (main, nav, header, footer)
- **PASS** Viewport meta tag correctly configured (no zoom restriction)
- **PASS** H1 heading present on 10 of 11 pages
- **PASS** External links in footer indicate "opens in a new tab"
- **PASS** Consistent 24–28 automated rules passed per page

4. Per-Page Audit Results

Page 1: Home

<https://www.utah.gov/index.html>

2 violations **27** passed **2** needs review **0** H1s **16** img issues **22** small targets

Unique issues: Missing H1 heading, duplicate ID, auto-rotating hero without pause control. Only page without H1.

Page 2: Online Services

<https://www.utah.gov/services/>

1 violation **27** passed **2** needs review **1** H1 **24** img issues **48** small targets

Notable: Highest image issue count (24 of 31 images). 19 elements flagged for potential contrast issues. 48 undersized touch targets — second highest across all pages.

Page 3: Government

<https://www.utah.gov/government/>

2 violations **26** passed **2** needs review **1** H1 **4** img issues **43** small targets

Unique issues: 14 confirmed color contrast violations (navigation links). Empty link to auditor.utah.gov. Heading skip H2→H5 for "Map Legend".

Page 4: Business

<https://www.utah.gov/business/>

1 violation **26** passed **2** needs review **1** H1 **8** img issues **35** small targets

Notable: 28 elements need contrast review — highest across all pages. Duplicate heading text ("Starting a Business", "Running a Business", "Closing a Business" appear twice each).

Page 5: Employment

<https://www.utah.gov/employment/>

1 violation **26** passed **2** needs review **1** H1 **8** img issues **21** small targets

Notable: Fewest touch target issues (21). Relatively clean page with only the systemic logo link issue.

Page 6: Education

<https://www.utah.gov/education/>

1 violation 26 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 9 img issues 28 small targets

Notable: Contains embedded YouTube iframe (with proper title, unlike Visit page). Clean heading hierarchy.

Page 7: Visit Utah

<https://www.utah.gov/visit/>

2 violations 24 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 22 img issues 37 small targets

Unique issues: YouTube iframe missing `title` attribute (`frame-title` violation). 22 images without proper alt. Fewest automated passes (24).

Page 8: Residents (Local)

<https://www.utah.gov/local/>

1 violation 28 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 29 img issues 53 small targets

Notable: Most images issues (29 of 40) and most small touch targets (53) of all pages. Heading skip H2→H5. Most content-rich page with dynamic location data, jobs, meetings, and social media widgets.

Page 9: About

<https://www.utah.gov/about/>

1 violation 26 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 11 img issues 32 small targets

Notable: Two heading level skips (H1→H3 and H2→H5). 23 elements need contrast review. Features "About" subsection with H3 "Featured" where H2 would be expected.

Page 10: Disclaimer (Terms of Use)

<https://www.utah.gov/support/disclaimer.html>

1 violation 24 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 4 img issues 25 small targets

Notable: Simple text-heavy page. Clean heading hierarchy. Only systemic issues present.

Page 11: Accessibility

<https://www.utah.gov/support/accessibility.html>

2 violations 28 passed 2 needs review 1 H1 4 img issues 25 small targets

Ironical issue: The accessibility page itself has a confirmed color contrast violation on the green "Submit" button. Includes a well-structured accessibility reporting form with reCAPTCHA.

5. Page Structure Analysis for EDS Migration

5.1 Technology Stack

Property	Value
Framework	Utah Design System (UTDS) — Custom
React / Angular / Vue	None detected
CMS	Custom (not WordPress)
Third-party	Google Translate, Qualtrics Feedback, UtahID SSO, YouTube embeds, Google Maps (WebGL)

5.2 Template Classification

Template	Pages	Characteristics
Homepage	1	Hero with rotating images, search bar, persona pills, card grids (Featured Services, Utah Local, Visiting Utah)
Category Landing	7	Services, Government, Business, Employment, Education, Visit, Residents — H1 + Featured cards + YouTube embed + sub-nav sidebar
Content/Support	2	Disclaimer, Accessibility — H1 + long-form text content + sub-nav sidebar
About	1	H1 + cards + interactive map + sub-nav sidebar

5.3 Section-to-Block Mapping

Section Pattern	EDS Block	Found On
Government trust banner	Header (default content)	All 11 pages
Logo + UtahID + hamburger	Header / Navigation	All 11 pages
Hero image + search bar	Hero block	Homepage
Persona chips ("I am:")	Tags / Pills block	Homepage
Featured cards (icon + title + subtitle)	Cards block	8 pages
YouTube video embed	Embed block	4 pages
Interactive map (WebGL)	Embed block (custom)	3 pages

Section Pattern	EDS Block	Found On
Social media feed	Cards block (social variant)	2 pages
Agency/resource list	List block	3 pages
Long-form text content	Default content (sections)	2 pages
Accessibility report form	Form block	1 page
Side navigation	Section nav (aside)	10 pages
Footer + legal links	Footer	All 11 pages

6. EDS Migration Plan with Accessibility Remediation

1 Foundation & Design System Setup

- Extract design tokens from UTDS (navy #071D49, gold #F0B429, green, white; typography; spacing)
- Set up EDS project with `styles.css` and `scripts.js`
- Configure navigation (`nav.html`) from `utah.gov` header structure
- Define CSS custom properties with **WCAG-compliant color pairs** (fix contrast at token level)

2 Block Development (with Accessibility Fixes)

Block	A11y Fix
Header	Add <code>aria-label="Utah.gov Home"</code> to logo link (fixes #1, all 11 pages). Ensure <code>aria-expanded</code> on hamburger. Fix ARIA attribute value (#4).
Hero	Add H1 heading (fixes #6). Add pause control for rotation (#12). Enforce 4.5:1 contrast overlay.
Cards	Set <code>role="presentation"</code> or meaningful alt on icons (fixes #3). Min touch target 44×44px (#5).
Embed	Auto-add <code>title</code> attribute to iframes (fixes #8).
Form	Ensure all inputs have labels. Fix Submit button contrast (fixes #10).
Section Nav	Fix heading hierarchy — no H2→H5 skips (#7). Use appropriate heading levels.
Footer	Maintain "opens in new tab" pattern. Ensure all links have names.

3 Content Migration (3 Templates)

- **Homepage template:** Hero + persona pills + 3 card grids + footer
- **Category landing template:** H1 + featured cards + video embed + sidebar nav (7 pages)
- **Content/support template:** H1 + long-form text + optional form + sidebar nav (3 pages)
- Verify heading hierarchy per page: H1 > H2 > H3 (no skips)
- Add proper image alt text for all icons during authoring

4 Accessibility Remediation Summary

Issue	Pages Fixed	EDS Strategy
Logo link name	11/11	Header block JS adds <code>aria-label</code> automatically
Color contrast	11/11	WCAG-compliant tokens in <code>styles.css</code> ; hero overlay gradient
Image alt text	11/11	EDS content model requires explicit alt text per image
ARIA attr value	11/11	Fix in shared header block JS
Touch targets	11/11	<code>min-height: 44px</code> in block CSS for all interactive elements
Missing H1	1/11	Hero block includes H1 in content model
Heading skips	3/11	EDS heading hierarchy enforced per template
iframe title	1/11	Embed block auto-adds <code>title</code>
Empty link	1/11	Content fix during migration authoring
Submit contrast	1/11	Button color token updated to pass 4.5:1

5 Validation & Testing

- Run axe-core on all 11 migrated pages — target **zero violations**
- Manual keyboard navigation test on all 3 templates
- Screen reader testing (NVDA + Chrome, VoiceOver + Safari)
- Lighthouse accessibility audit (target 95+ on all pages)
- Verify touch targets at mobile viewports (320px, 375px, 414px)
- Test `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` on homepage hero
- Validate contrast on all hero/map/video background variations

7. Appendix: Detailed Data Tables

A. Image Accessibility Issues by Page

Page	Total Images	Problematic	% Affected
Home	18	16	89%
Online Services	31	24	77%
Government	16	4	25%
Business	10	8	80%
Employment	10	8	80%
Education	12	9	75%
Visit Utah	24	22	92%
Residents	40	29	73%
About	12	11	92%
Disclaimer	6	4	67%
Accessibility	6	4	67%
TOTAL	185	139	75%

B. Touch Target Issues by Page

Page	Total Interactive	Below 44×44px	% Affected
Home	102	22	22%
Online Services	122	48	39%
Government	122	43	35%
Business	106	35	33%
Employment	92	21	23%
Education	100	28	28%
Visit Utah	111	37	33%
Residents	136	53	39%
About	106	32	30%
Disclaimer	93	25	27%
Accessibility	93	25	27%

Page	Total Interactive	Below 44×44px	% Affected
TOTAL	1,183	369	31%

C. Violation Summary Matrix

Issue	Home	Svcs	Gov	Biz	Empl	Edu	Visit	Local	About	Disc	A11y
Logo link (no name)	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Color contrast	?	?	X	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	X
Image alt issues	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
ARIA attr value	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?
Touch targets <44px	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Missing H1	X	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Heading skip	-	-	X	-	-	-	-	X	X	-	-
iframe without title	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	-	-	-	-
Empty link	-	-	X	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

X = Confirmed violation
 ? = Needs manual review
 - = Pass

This report was generated using axe-core 4.7.2 automated testing supplemented with manual accessibility checks across 11 pages.

For questions or to begin the migration process, contact your Adobe EDS team.